The Noble Vidyā-Mantra Called Purifying the Eye

Ārya-cakṣurviśodhanī-nāma-vidyāmantra · Toh 1008 · Derge Kangyur
འཕགས་པ་མཐོ་རན་པར་སྦྱོང་བ་ཞེས་བྱ་བ་བྱང་འདི་སྐད།

The Noble Vidyā-Mantra Called Purifying the Eye, known in Sanskrit as Āryacakṣurviśodhanī nāma vidyāmantra and in Tibetan as Pakpa Mik Nampar Jongwa Zhejawé Rikngak, is a short scripture centered on a vidyāmantra, a spell of awareness, whose title points to the purification and healing of the eyes. It opens in the classic sutra manner, with the Blessed One staying among the Śākyas, and introduces a devout Śākya named Sukha, whose unwavering faith in the Buddha, the Dharma, and the Saṅgha is described at length and sets the scene for the teaching of the mantra. Works of this kind present protective and healing formulas within the framework of the Buddha's teaching, offering practical benefit to those who recite them with faith. The text is Toh 1008 in the Kangyur, where it belongs among the dhāraṇī and mantra texts gathered in the canon's collection of incantations.

In the language of India: ārya cakṣurbiśodhani nāma bidyāmantra. In the language of Tibet: The Noble Vidyā-Mantra Called Purifying the Eye.

Homage to all the buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was staying among the Śākyas in a fine town of the Śākyas. At that time, in a place called Statusa, there lived a Śākya called Sukha. He had deep faith in the Buddha, and deep faith in the Dharma and the Saṅgha. He had gone for refuge to the Buddha, gone for refuge to the Dharma, and gone for refuge to the Saṅgha. He was single-mindedly turned toward the Buddha, single-mindedly turned toward the Dharma, and single-mindedly turned toward the Saṅgha. He was free of hesitation and free of doubt about the Buddha, and free of hesitation and free of doubt about the Dharma, the Saṅgha, suffering, its origin, its cessation, and the path. He had seen the truths, attained the fruit, and reached direct realization, and he had laid down weapons and the rod.

While he was living in this way, forms both visible and invisible ceased to appear to his eyes. Faith in the Buddha, the Blessed One, then arose in him, and keeping him in mind he said: "Homage to the Buddha, the Blessed One! Homage to the Buddha, the Blessed One, the maker of light, the holder of the lamp, the holder of radiance! Sugata, endowed with great compassion, please make things clear! Blessed One, please purify my eyes!"

When he had said this, the Blessed One, who was dwelling in a divine abiding, heard the words Sukha had spoken with his divine ear, pure and surpassing that of humans. Having heard them, he rose from that samādhi and said to the venerable Ānanda:

"Ānanda, go, and with this vidyā-mantra for purifying the eye, protect the Śākya Sukha. Bring about his complete holding, his complete protection, and his complete guarding; pacification and well-being; the averting of punishment and the averting of weapons; the neutralizing of poison and the destroying of poison; the sealing of the boundaries and the binding of the ground. In the same way, purify also the eyes of the fourfold assembly, the monks, nuns, laymen and laywomen, and of other sentient beings. Purify the sockets of the eyes. Make the eyes free of defects.

tadyathā hili mili kili mili hilite mili huyā huyā hū ā mani hulu hulu hulu hudu hudu hudu cakṣur me biśodhaya svāhā

"Ānanda, this queen of vidyās, Purifying the Eye, removes disorders of the eye, disorders of wind, disorders of bile, disorders of phlegm, and disorders arising from their combination. By the truth of moral discipline, the truth of ascetic vows, the truth of the sages, the truth of dependent origination, the truth of suffering, the truth of its origin, the truth of its cessation, the truth of the path, the truth of the arhats, the truth of the pratyekabuddhas, and the truth of the buddhas, the blessed ones, may the eyes of the Śākya Sukha not ache! May they not shed tears! May they not stream with tears all over! May the eyes of myself and of all sentient beings become completely pure! svāhā

"Ānanda, this queen of vidyās, Purifying the Eye, was spoken by six perfectly complete buddhas. I too now teach it, and the Four Great Kings, Śakra the lord of the gods, and Brahmā the lord of the Sahā world also rejoice in it.

"Ānanda, if anyone recites this vidyā three times a day, I do not see, in the world with its gods, its māras and its Brahmās, among its population of ascetics and brahmins, gods, humans and asuras, that he could be struck by dimness of sight, by blurred vision, by cataract, by the eye disease in which things are seen as blue, or by disorders of the visual field arising from gods, from nāgas, from gandharvas, from yakṣas, from rākṣasas, from piśācas, from sorcery, from vetālas, from vetālas together with sorcery, from wandering spirits, or from wandering spirits together with vetālas. That is impossible."

The venerable Ānanda listened to the Blessed One and said, "So be it, Blessed One." He took up these mantra formulas, mastered them fully, and went to where the Śākya Sukha was. There he told him at length: "Sukha, the Tathāgata has entrusted to you these mantra formulas for purifying the eye. Call them to mind three times each and every day."

The very moment the Śākya Sukha heard them, his eyes were completely purified, and with his eyes completely purified he saw everything with stainless eyes.

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, the venerable Ānanda, the Śākya Sukha, and the world with its gods rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

This completes the noble vidyā-mantra called Purifying the Eye.

Translator's Notes

• The layman's name, Tibetan bde ba "happiness," is given as Sukha, its standard Sanskrit equivalent. The original Indian form is not otherwise attested here. Statusa is a Tibetan transcription of an unidentified place name and is kept as written. In the list of protective acts, chad pa spang ba is rendered "averting punishment" (daṇḍa), its sense in this stock protective formula, not "annihilation." "Wandering spirits" renders kun du rgyu, a class of beings whose Sanskrit name is uncertain in this context. "Sorcery" renders byad, probably Skt. kṛtyā, harmful magic or the beings it sends.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.